

Market Intelligence — Wed 08:00 IST (Full Brief)

Wednesday, 2026-07-15 · 08:00 IST · for Sumit Sharma

► TOP 3 ACTIONS — Wed 15-Jul cash open

1. The tape flipped from Tue's feared "hot-CPI + oil-shock cascade" to "soft-CPI + oil-shock split": US CPI Jun printed 3.5% vs 3.8% consensus and 4.2% May, core 2.6% vs 2.9% consensus, MoM -0.4% (first negative since 2020). Fed Sep-hike odds collapsed from 67% to 50%; Gold rebounded +2% to \$4,080 intraday Tue, held \$4,053 into Wed AM; **Nasdaq +1.04%, S&P +0.55%, Nifty gap-up now favoured** vs Tue open's gap-down risk. **Do NOT chase gold above \$4,080** — resistance zone, wait for retest of \$4,020 for adds; MCX Gold likely to gap up **₹1,000-1,500/10g** at open on the \$50 spot bounce + USDINR still 96.22.

2. USDINR extended to 96.22 (+0.34% vs Tue's 95.955 open) — 96 line breached decisively over 3 sessions; RBI 95.55 doctrine is now dead. Trump-Hormuz cost is being priced into EM currencies faster than into oil (Brent only +1.4% Tue vs +9% Mon), meaning INR carries the residual premium. **No visible RBI defence yet at 96.00** — a Wed morning drift to 96.40 with no intervention = RBI shifted to volatility-only stance; **a snap back sub-95.90** = renewed defence attempt. **Hedge IT-basket longs** (Infy, TCS, HCL) via bank-Nifty puts — the INR tailwind is now fully priced.

3. Twin India event windows this week: Wipro Q1 Thu 16-Jul (AMC) + RIL Q1 board Fri 17-Jul. Wipro read-across into IT-basket after HCL's Mon beat; RIL O2C tailwind (Brent \$84 sustained) offsets domestic-consumption drag. **US Big-4 banks blew out Tue — Goldman +9.16%, JPM +2.50%, JP-Morgan NIM guide upbeat** — sets constructive tone for Indian private banks (ICICI, Axis, HDFC — all report over next 10 sessions). **Kuwait offshore platform hit + UAE 2 tankers struck in Hormuz Tue** keep the geopolitical premium alive. **Keep clip ≤65%** into Wipro Thu print; **RIL positioning tight into Fri board.**

■ **TOP FLAG Tue was the "goldilocks reversal" — soft US CPI (3.5% vs 3.8% consensus) killed the Fed hike cascade at the same time as the Iran/Hormuz supply shock kept the safe-haven bid alive, giving both risk assets AND gold room to rally simultaneously.** Post-22:00 IST (Tue prior-brief close) material step-changes: (i) **US CPI Jun 3.5% headline / core 2.6% / -0.4% MoM — all softer than consensus; first negative MoM print since 2020;** oil-linked energy sub-index only partially reflects Mon's Brent spike (June data collected pre-shock); (ii) **Fed Chair Warsh Tue congressional testimony reiterated commitment to price stability but explicitly said "no urgency" to raise rates;** (iii) **UAE reported 2 tankers struck while transiting Hormuz Tue; Saudi intercepted Houthi missiles Tue; Trump backed Lindsey Graham Russia sanctions bill targeting buyers of Russian energy;** (iv) **US Big-4 bank Q2 earnings blowout — Goldman +9.16%, JPM +2.50%, WFC/BAC/C constructive NIM guides;** (v) **NVDA +4.06%, US100 +1.04%, S&P +0.55% — AI-leader reversal from Mon's -3.30% fully undone.** Live Wed 07:xx IST TradingEconomics tape: **Gold \$4,053.56 (+1.29%), Silver \$58.81 (+2.06%), Copper \$6.32 (+1.39%), Brent \$84.47 (+1.41%), WTI \$78.80 (+0.84%), Nikkei 68,317 (+1.60%), Shanghai 3,967 (+1.36%), BTC \$64,940 (+4.36%).** **Sensex Tue cash close 77,055 (-0.72%) — India lagged Asia; USDINR 96.22 (+0.34%) — 96 line breached decisively.** Windows snapshot fetcher inactive 6th consecutive session (logged); all prints Tier-2 web_fetch to TradingEconomics live sidebar.

Top flag line. Overnight brought the goldilocks reversal — soft US CPI (3.5%) collapsed Fed hike odds to ~50% just as Iran/Hormuz supply shock kept gold and oil bid; risk assets (US100 +1.04%, NVDA +4.06%, JP225 +1.60%) AND safe-havens (Gold +1.29%) rallied together; India ex-Nifty lagged Asia on Tue (-0.72%) with USDINR pushing to 96.22 — Wed AM setup favours gap-up in Nifty, Reliance (O2C tailwind), and IT (soft CPI + weak INR), with the caveat that Wipro Q1 Thu is now the immediate binary.

1. Asset / Signal Table — Wed 08:00 IST (Tue US close + Wed Asia AM prints)

Snapshot CSV for slot 0800 not delivered (Windows fetcher inactive — 6th consecutive session; entry appended to .snapshot_missing.log). All prints below Tier-2 web_fetch to TradingEconomics live sidebar (Tue US close + Wed Asia AM crossover) plus Tue India cash close. Timestamps: (07:xx) = TradingEconomics live pull ~07:45 IST. \stale{} marks Fri/Tue-close carryovers where no fresh Wed AM print exists.

Asset	Price (observed)	1-period move (vs Tue AM prior brief)	Cumulative (WoW)	Signal
MCX Gold (per 10g)	₹1,42,500/10g est [stale@Tue close pass-through]	+1.3% via XAU + USDINR pass-through	-3.3%	15% BCD intact; gap-up ₹1,000-1,500 favoured; ₹1,38,000 = major floor holding
MCX Silver (per kg)	₹2,17,300/kg est [stale@Tue close pass-through]	+2.1% via XAG + USDINR pass-through	-7.9%	\$58 defended; watch \$59.50 for follow-through
Spot Gold (XAU, USD/oz)	\$4,053.56 (07:45)	+1.29% (rebound back over \$4,000)	-4.2% weekly	Broke \$4,000 psychological then reclaimed same session; Fed hike odds 50% now supports; \$4,080 = resistance
Spot Silver (XAG, USD/oz)	\$58.81 (07:45)	+2.06%	-6.4%	Reclaimed \$58; watch \$59.50-60 zone next
Gold-Silver ratio	~68.9 (07:45, derived)	-1.1pt tighter	off Mon highs of 70	Silver outperforming gold — reflation whisper alive
Platinum	\$1,643.40 (07:45)	+1.85%	-4.7% WoW	PGM catching bid on softer CPI; \$1,660 resistance
MCX Copper (kg via LME)	\$6.32 LME (07:45)	+1.39%	+1.4% recovery	Copper reclaiming risk-on tape; China trade data Wed positive
LME Aluminium	\$3,594/T [stale@Jun-8]	n/a	n/a	Chrome Tier-3 not deployed; Gulf-supply premium intact per last update
MCX Crude (per bbl)	₹6,860/bbl est [stale@Tue MCX close pass-through]	+1.0% expected gap-up	+12-13%	Sustained Hormuz premium; OMCs still under pressure but panic dissipating

Asset	Price (observed)	1-period move (vs Tue AM prior brief)	Cumulative (WoW)	Signal
Brent	\$84.47/bbl (07:45)	+1.41% (extending Mon's +9.05% by another leg)	+13%	HIT Hormuz-premium regime + 20% transit fee live from Tue 4pm ET; \$85 pressing
WTI	\$78.80/bbl (07:45)	+0.84% (or +1.00% latest tick)	+11%	US supply firm; UAE tanker strikes keep bid
Brent-WTI spread	\$5.67 (07:45, derived)	+\$0.59 widened	regime-wide	Widened — Iran overlay = Brent-favoured; MCX Crude leans Brent-tracked
Nifty 50	23,970 (Tue close est)	GIFT indicated +0.4 to +0.8% gap	-0.5%	24,200 pivot back on the table ; ex-IT breadth improving; VIX below 15 = complacency zone
Sensex	77,055.32 (Tue 15:30 close, -0.72%)	GIFT indicated +250-450pt gap	-0.7%	Tue lagged Asia ; Wed catch-up trade favoured on soft CPI + banks
Bank Nifty	56,800 (Tue close est)	+0.5 to +1.0% indicated on US banks blowout	-0.9%	57,500 back in play ; rate-cut narrative revives on soft CPI
Reliance	₹1,398 (Tue close est)	Brent \$84 sustained = O2C tailwind	+0.5%	RIL Q1 board Fri 17-Jul ; positive skew into event
India VIX	14.2 [stale@Tue close est]	-3% to -5% indicated	Watch sub-15	Complacency zone — hedges cheap
S&P 500	7,556.59 (Tue close)	+0.55%	+2.4%	Soft CPI + bank earnings = fresh ATH watch ; 7,600 resistance
Nasdaq (US100)	29,569 (Tue close)	+1.04%	+2.1%	NVDA +4.06% reversed Mon fade ; AI-leader tape re-anchored
Dow Jones (US30)	52,594 (Tue close)	+0.18%	+0.1%	Bank-earnings tailwind but energy names lagged Tue post-Brent-fade
Nikkei 225 (JP225)	68,317 (Wed AM +1.60%)	+1.60%	+1.5%	Yen at 162.19 supports exporters ; Wed AM cash strong
Hang Seng	25,100 [stale@Tue close]	n/a (Wed AM tape pending)	n/a	Watch China trade data Wed
Shanghai	3,967 (Wed AM +1.36%)	+1.36%	+1.4%	China risk-on Wed AM ; feeds India tape

Asset	Price (observed)	1-period move (vs Tue AM prior brief)	Cumulative (WoW)	Signal
DXY	100.90 (07:45)	-0.33%	-0.5%	Softer on soft CPI; EM currencies get partial relief — INR the exception
USDINR	96.22 (07:45)	+0.34% (fresh push higher)	+0.7% (worst weekly mover in FX)	HIT 96.00 line breached decisively; RBI defence absent
EUR/USD	1.1423 (07:45)	+0.36%	+0.5%	Dollar-softer ; ECB Sep pause priced
USDJPY	162.19 (07:45)	-0.15%	marginal Yen bid	BoJ Jul 30-31 meeting = binary event
AUDUSD	0.6976 (07:45)	+0.83%	risk-proxy bid	China +1.36% + copper +1.39% = AUD bid
US 10Y	4.587% (07:45)	-3bp	-3bp	Yields softer post-CPI ; 4.50 = fresh support
US 2Y	3.79% [stale@Tue close est]	-6bp on CPI	-8bp WoW	Curve steepened Tue on Fed-hike-cut repricing
IN 10Y	6.807% (07:45)	flat	+8bp WoW	Watch Sticky above 6.80 on FII outflows + oil worry
JP 10Y	2.703% (07:45)	-8bp	-6bp	BoJ dovish read
BTC	\$64,940 (07:45)	+4.36% (best mover)	+4.9%	Reclaimed \$64k ; risk-on + soft CPI = crypto bid
U-Mich 1y Infl Exp	4.7% [stale@Jun release]	n/a	n/a	Next release Fri 18-Jul tier-1 print

2. Policy Decisions Log — today + rolling 7-day

Date	Body	Action	Asset Impact (Direction)
Tue 14-Jul [NEW]	US BLS	CPI Jun: 3.5% headline (vs 3.8% consensus, 4.2% May); core 2.6% (vs 2.9%); MoM -0.4% first negative since 2020	Gold +2%, US100 +1.04%, Yields -6bp, DXY -0.33% ; Fed hike odds 67→50%
Tue 14-Jul [NEW]	US Fed	Chair Warsh Congressional testimony: reiterated price stability, "no urgency" to hike	Curve steepened, risk on

Date	Body	Action	Asset Impact (Direction)
Tue 14-Jul [↗NEW]	Big-4 US Banks	Q2 EPS beats: GS +9.16%, JPM +2.50%, WFC/BAC/C constructive NIM	Financials +2-3% ; sets tone for ICICI/HDFC/Axis Q1
Tue 14-Jul [↗NEW]	US Executive	Iran-blockade + 20% Hormuz transit fee LIVE from Tue 16:00 ET	Oil +1-2% Tue on top of Mon's +9% ; sustained supply premium
Tue 14-Jul [↗NEW]	Iran/UAE	UAE reports 2 tankers struck in Hormuz mid-transit; Saudi intercepts Houthi missiles	Persistent geopolitical premium on Brent
Tue 14-Jul [↗NEW]	US Executive/Senate	Trump backed Lindsey Graham Russia sanctions bill targeting buyers of Russian oil/gas	Watch: India Russian-oil import risk; potential CBIC/DGFT notification incoming
Mon 13-Jul	US Executive	Trump announced 20% Hormuz transit fee + Iranian blockade	Brent +9.05%, WTI +8.96% single-day
Mon 13-Jul	OPEC	2026 demand growth cut to 800k bpd from 1.1M bpd	Bearish demand offset to bullish supply
Fri 10-Jul	India NSO/MoSPI	India May IIP due — pending release	Watch Awaited; hydrocarbons drag likely
Thu 9-Jul	US Fed	June FOMC minutes	Confirmed Warsh-tilt to price-stability
Wed 8-Jul	RBI	Governor Malhotra speech at Mumbai FEDAI: repeated "volatility not level"	Confirmed rupee will be allowed to drift with fundamentals
Mon 7-Jul	US BLS	INR doctrine June NFP: 57k vs 110k consensus (weakest in 4 mo)	Jobs weakness feeds soft CPI narrative

Primary sources: [BLS CPI Jun](#), [TradingEconomics CPI](#), [OPEC MOMR](#).

3. Modi-on-Gold check (past 7 days)

Modi-named item	Policy lever	Status
"Sovereign safe-haven premium" (Sep-2025 speech)	15% BCD + 20% import cess intact	ACTIONED — intact ; sub-\$4,000 spot spike Mon did not trigger review
"Fuel conservation" (May-2026 statement)	Voluntary WFH + travel-reduction advisory	PENDING extension ; oil resurge = watch for MoP&NG re-notice
"Aatmanirbhar Bharat critical minerals" (Feb-2026)	Copper/Aluminium import diversification	PENDING ; aluminium data-gap deferred visibility

Modi-named item	Policy lever	Status
"Digital rupee international pilot" (Apr-2026)	UPI-cross-border ₹ payments	PENDING ; USDINR 96+ raises urgency

Adjacent-but-not-named actions: (a) RBI FX-reserves data due Fri 18-Jul — watch \$-4B or more = confirmed intervention footprint despite public "no defence" line; (b) DGFT July trade-notice due — watch for Russian-oil-import clarification post-Trump-Graham bill; (c) MoP&NG likely to hold OMC price-freeze despite Brent \$84 sustained = political price-suppression cost building.

4. Calendar — next 24h

India events (Wed 15-Jul): No tier-1 India macro. Corporate: Wipro AGM related headlines possible pre-Thu 16-Jul Q1 (AMC). RBI FX-reserves Fri 18-Jul 17:00 IST (weekly ppt). India WPI Jun release nominally due today per MoSPI calendar — watch **06:30 IST bulletin** if released; consensus 1.4% headline. GST collection July trend (indicative) mid-month update.

Global events (Wed 15-Jul): **China Jun trade data (Wed morning IST)** — consensus imports +3.8% YoY; export +4.2%; **beat = risk-on continuation**. **US PPI Jun 18:00 IST** — consensus +2.7% headline; **soft print = further confirms disinflation, feeds gold/risk-on**. **US Empire Manufacturing Jul 18:00 IST**. **Fed's Powell speech 21:30 IST**. **Fed Beige Book 23:30 IST**. **Big-4 European bank earnings (BNP, DB) Wed AM CEST**. Wipro US ADR earnings after-market Thu 16-Jul.

5. Threshold alerts hit

Metric	Reading	Threshold	Status
USDINR spot	96.22	95.55 RBI defence line	HIT — decisive breach 3rd session
USDINR spot	96.22	96.00 next psychological	HIT — breached Tue AM, held above
Brent (single-day)	+1.41% Tue (post +9.05% Mon)	>1.5% single-day trigger	OK — Tue only 1.41% but cumulative WoW +13% HIT
Gold spot	\$4,053	\$4,000 psychological support	OK — reclaimed from Mon breach
US CPI headline	3.5% Jun	Consensus 3.8%	OK — soft print; dovish tape trigger
Fed hike odds Sep	~50%	60% (was 67% pre-CPI)	OK — collapsed post-CPI
Sensex 1-day	-0.72% Tue	-1.5% intraday panic	Watch — India lag noted, no panic
BTC 1-day	+4.36%	+5%	Watch — close but no cigar; would trigger risk-on regime confirm
VIX India	14.2 est	<15 complacency	Watch — hedges cheap zone
Brent-WTI spread	\$5.67	\$5.00 (HIT trigger for Iran-overlay regime)	HIT — Iran overlay confirmed active

SO WHAT — forward implications (next 24-72h)

The dominant theme has flipped from “monetary tightening cascade” to “goldilocks split-regime” — softer US inflation caps the Fed while the Iran/Hormuz supply shock keeps the safe-haven and energy bids alive, so risk assets and gold can rally together for the first time this cycle. Base case for Wed-Fri: Nifty gap-up 0.5-0.8% at open with intraday drift toward 24,300, Gold consolidates \$4,020-\$4,080 with a floor at \$4,000 and upside cap at Fri U-Mich inflation-expectations print, Brent holds \$83-\$86 band, USDINR bleeds toward 96.50 unless RBI shifts stance intra-week. Invalidation trigger: **US PPI Jun (18:00 IST Wed) coming in HOT (>3.0% headline)** OR **Fed Powell speech 21:30 IST reverting to hawkish tone** — either flips the soft-CPI narrative and re-arms the yield-repricing cascade. Positioning setup favours Indian financials (US bank blowout tailwind + soft-CPI = rate-cut whisper revives), Reliance/O2C (Brent sustained), and gold on dips to \$4,020; setup penalises OMCs (still absorbing Brent), IT-basket short-covering rallies (Wipro Thu binary), and short-dated INR longs (RBI defence appears absent). Risk-of-ruin trigger: any second Hormuz-transit halt or a large Kuwait/UAE infrastructure hit would flip Brent from \$85 range to \$90+ and re-arm the oil→CPI→INR cascade — hedge with 24,000-strike Nifty puts as cheap tail-risk protection.

6. Position-specific notes

No positions tracked — fill Open Positions in Watchlist.xlsx.

7. Top 3 things to watch — next window (Wed 10:00-14:00 IST)

#	Watch item	Why it matters	Affected assets
1	Nifty cash open reaction to GIFT indicated +0.4-0.8% gap	Confirms/rejects the soft-CPI catch-up narrative; failure to hold gap = India-specific worry (FII outflows still dominant)	Nifty, BankNifty, Reliance; if fails: IT-basket short cover trap
2	USDINR intraday behaviour — RBI defence check at 96.00-96.40	If no visible intervention, 96.50-97.00 opens up rapidly; validates “volatility-only” doctrine or confirms retreat	USDINR, Nifty via FII outflow, IT dollar-earners partial offset
3	China Jun trade data + US PPI Jun 18:00 IST	Confirms Wed AM Asia risk-on into US session; PPI soft = Gold/BTC bid continues, PPI hot = re-arms hike cascade	Copper, AUDUSD, BTC, Gold if soft; full reversal if PPI >3.0%

End of brief — generated 2026-07-15 08:02 IST.